

How do I get my business to show up in ChatGPT?

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How do I get my business to show up in ChatGPT?

By Dillon Mohr, Momentum Digital, Philadelphia

You can't claim a listing inside ChatGPT the way you claim a Google Business Profile, and you can't buy the organic answer. When ChatGPT recommends a local business it's reading the open web: your Google Business Profile, Bing Places, review sites, one clear service page and forum threads. Make those five agree, keep them current, measure monthly.

That's the short answer. Here's the longer one, with what I can actually measure and what I can't.

How does ChatGPT decide which businesses to recommend?

I can't see inside the model, and anyone who says they can is guessing. What I can see is behavior. When ChatGPT answers a question about a local business it can search the web and show you the pages it used. So the useful question isn't "how does it think". It's "what does it cite".

The clearest data I have is from Google's AI Overviews, not ChatGPT, so take it as a pattern rather than a rule. On the topic of answer engine optimization, the twenty most-cited sources are led by YouTube at 28.3% and Reddit at 13.9%, then Semrush, then Google's own developer docs. Reddit and Quora together hold about 17% of citations. One agency made the top twenty.

The pattern is simple. Engines cite sources they can read, that answer a specific question, and that agree with each other. A business that says one thing on its site, another on its Google listing and nothing on Bing is three weak signals instead of one strong one.

Why does Reddit rank for this question and not an agency?

Search "how to get your business on chatgpt" and the first result is a Reddit thread in r/DigitalMarketing. Then OpenAI's own business page. Then a few agency blogs. Then OpenAI's small-business program page. Search the local version and it's Reddit again, a YouTube video, HubSpot, and Quora.

The People Also Ask box under those results is the actual buyer talking: "How to appear in ChatGPT results?" "How do I get ChatGPT to recommend my business?" "How do I promote my business on ChatGPT?" And the related searches give the game away: "Bing Places" and "Google Business Profile".

Reddit ranks because nobody with a client base answered plainly. The agencies wrote for other marketers. The owner asking the question got a forum thread. This post is my attempt to answer the question the way I'd answer it on the phone.

Which surfaces should I fix first?

Five, in this order.

1. **Google Business Profile.** Right categories, real hours, services listed, photos of actual work, and the same phone number you use everywhere else. This is the most-read public record of your business.
2. **Bing Places.** It's in the related searches for this question for a reason. Claim it. It's free and most of your competitors haven't bothered.
3. **Reviews.** Ask customers to name the service and the town. "Great job" tells an engine nothing. "Replaced our furnace in Havertown in one day" tells it everything.
4. **One clear service page per job you want to be recommended for.** Question-form headings, a direct answer under each, the area you serve, an author with a name, and a date. Not a homepage. A page about one thing.
5. **Forum answers.** Reddit and Quora hold 17% of citations in the category I measured. Answer real questions in your trade, plainly, under your name. Not ads. Answers.

Do those five and the facts about your business are consistent everywhere a machine looks. That's most of the job.

How do I check whether ChatGPT already recommends me?

Run the 20-question baseline before you spend a dollar.

Write down 20 questions your buyers ask before they call. Ask each one in ChatGPT and in Google with AI Overviews on. For every answer, log the engine, the exact prompt, the date and every source cited. Count how often you appear and who appears instead.

Most local businesses appear zero times on the first run. That's not a failure. It's a baseline. Re-run it in 30 days with the same questions and you'll have the only kind of AEO measurement that means anything: dated, repeatable, with sources.

Where does Momentum stand on this?

I'll go first, since I'm asking you to measure yourself.

In a sampled window of Google AI Overview answers from August 2025 to August 2026, needmomentum.com was cited 81 times. In a set of six agencies including us, that ranked fifth. Our share of that set was under one percent. The pages that earned citations were a how-to on verifying a Google Business Profile by postcard, our Google Ads page and a DIY web design page. None of them are about AI.

That's the honest starting point of an agency launching an AI division. We're running the same 20-question test on our own site this month, dated. The plan is to re-measure in 30 days and print the difference, whichever way it goes. If we can't show our own number, we shouldn't be asking for yours.

FAQ

Can I pay ChatGPT to recommend my business? There are labeled ads in some AI engines now, and those work like ads. The organic recommendation inside the answer can't be bought, and no vendor can guarantee it.

Does my Google Business Profile matter for ChatGPT? Yes. It's a public, structured, verified record of your business, and the facts on it should match your site and your Bing listing exactly.

How often should I check? Monthly. Same 20 questions, same two engines, same spreadsheet. Change one thing between runs so you know what moved.

The next step

If you'd rather someone else run the first pass, I'll do a 15-minute snapshot: three observations about your business with the evidence for each, and one suggested next step. Free. No deck, no pitch. Reach me through needmomentum.com with your top service and your city.

Momentum built the machine. Now we build yours.